> century. Has any man ever perceived a ‘real physical situation’? How is it possible that a reasonable person could today still believe that he can refute our essential knowledge and understanding by drawing up such a bloodless ghost?

Then he implored, “Patience!” and went on to defend his views skillfully, carefully explaining the unanswered challenge of the EPR experiment yet again. But, despite his own views, Einstein’s work remained a source of positivist inspiration for Heisenberg, Pauli, Frank, the Vienna Circle, and a whole generation of German physicists.

Einstein’s work also inspired other positivist-leaning philosophies to spring up of their own accord outside of Vienna and Copenhagen. In 1927, Percy Bridgman, an experimental physicist working at Harvard, articulated a philosophy of science that he called *operationalism.* In his book, *The Logic of Modern Physics,* he opened the discussion by explicitly ascribing his inspiration to Einstein’s theories of special and general relativity. “There can be no doubt that through these theories physics is permanently changed,” Bridgman wrote. “Although [Einstein] himself does not explicitly state or emphasize it, I believe that a study of what he has done will show that he has essentially modified our view of what the concepts useful in physics are and should be.” Bridgman went on to claim that Einstein had shown that all scientific concepts must have operational definitions, definitions in terms of some kind of concrete experimental procedure. So “temperature,” for example, must be defined as “what a mercury thermometer measures.” To Bridgman, the deep insight of relativity was that operational definitions were the most fundamental definitions available for scientific concepts. “In general, we mean by any concept nothing more than a set of operations; *the concept is synonymous with the corresponding set of operations.*” Bridgman was a leading American physicist, who went on to win a Nobel Prize in 1946; the Vienna Circle, naturally, was thrilled to find such a prominent physicist espousing a philosophy of science so similar to their own and invited Bridgman to its International Congress for the Unity of Science in 1939.